

RE: AI MARKETING OPERATIONS MANAGER — EXCLUSIVE RESORTS

Hi Exclusive Resorts team,

I'd like to apply for the AI Marketing Operations Manager role. My specialty is something most marketing-ops candidates don't claim: **I'm a solutions engineer who specialized into marketing.** When a marketing team has accumulated a dozen tools that half-overlap, four lifecycle flows nobody can fully explain, three reporting cadences that contradict each other, and a "we should be using AI for this" backlog the size of a Notion graveyard — **I'm the person you call.**

Where I'd start at ER specifically: **personalization and segmentation.** Luxury travelers assume personalization now — the member who's flagged Tuscany three times this year and the one who's reliably in Aspen every March are two different people, and the marketing should reflect that. Four moves:

- 1 Profile.** Capture interests (ski, wellness, culture, food, family), aspirational destinations, preferred type of travel (multigenerational, slow, adventure, restorative), and life-stage signals. Layer behavioral data on top — properties favored, regions browsed, length-of-stay searches.
- 2 Segment.** Rule-based for the obvious ("members with kids under 12 + flagged interest in Costa Rica"). LLM-clustered for the emergent ("the 'late-fall European cities' set"). Both deserve a place in the audience library.
- 3 Trigger.** A new property in a member's wishlist country. A region matching their travel pattern just opened. Last-trip anniversary. Be opinionated about which moments actually earn outreach.
- 4 Accelerate with AI.** Claude is unreasonably good at "summarize this member's last five trips in one sentence" and "draft three variants for these three segments." Shortens the gap between member behavior and inbox-landing from weeks to days.

The deliverable is a member who feels *seen* — and a marketing org that ships smarter, not more.

For the last six months I've been **founding technical advisor at Upstream AI**, where my day-job is building **Claude Code sub-agents, versioned prompt libraries, and RAG pipelines** for non-technical end-users. The toolkit you're hiring for is the one I already use. The role is part-time and structured so I can step back to advisory for the right full-time seat — which this is.

Marketing-ops track record: **+30% closed-won at Zayo** (lead-scoring), **4x MQLs at Teren** (full GTM stack), **CDP delivery at Lytics**, and a **lifecycle email product at Homebot**.

On travel and luxury — it's lived experience. Family travel through **Tanzania, Bali, Costa Rica, Patagonia, Denmark, France, Germany, and Spain** before I was twenty; multiple years living abroad in **Haiti, India, the Philippines, and Indonesia** on development and research work. **I understand both the joys and pains of travel.**

→ engelsted.co/exclusive-resorts.html

Long-form version of this letter — receipts, the four-step framework laid out properly, and a brief audit of how I'd approach the first 90 days.

Thanks for reading — I'd love a 30-minute call to walk through how I'd audit one of your real marketing workflows. Worst case you get a free audit; best case you've found your hire.

Katrina Engelsted

SOLUTIONS ENGINEER + MARKETING OPS · BOULDER, CO